China and India has endowed it with a pot of riches, as royal patrons once did for Nalanda. In 2010, the Indian Parliament passed the Nalanda Bill, bringing the university into legal existence.

A brand-new campus with an innovative pedagogy and architectural motifs inspired by Nalanda Mahavihara is being built with eco-friendly features like recycled waste and water, renewable energy self-sufficiency, walking and biking paths, electric shuttles, ponds, etc.[49] However, from what I see during my visit to the construction site in mid-2018, it'll need much luck to become operational before 2025. Mainly a residential postgraduate institute, it'll have schools of Buddhist studies, philosophy and comparative religion; historical studies; international relations and peace; languages and literature; ecology and environmental studies; and more.

Will the new university attract students and faculty despite its backwater location?[50] Will it distinguish itself as did Nalanda Mahavihara, while avoiding the latter's costly mistakes? Will the budding university, now in an interim location a mile away, survive the politics of Hindutva nationalism that's already interfering with its mission?[51] At least going by its foundational goals, the new Nalanda University is explicitly 'aimed at advancing the concept of an Asian community . . . and rediscovering old relationships'.[52] Xuanzang and Yijing would surely have approved.